

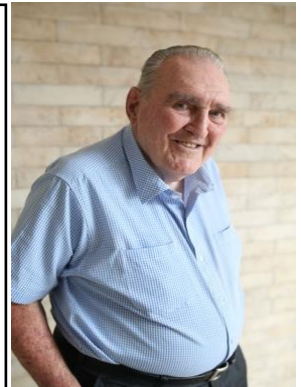


The Garamut
“The message sender”

Ps Barry's Reflections from 'The WORD'!

**For PRAYER,
 PROCLAMATION &
 PERSONAL PROGRESS**

**Bethel Global Missions
 No.2. for 9th February 2026**



Our Theme: ONE THING

In this reflection we will look at the significance of being singular in our thinking patterns, our prayers and the prioritizing of our desires and aspirations that we have in relation to God and his will.

I am sure that we all have several things that we would like God to do for us but there are times when we must prioritize those desires and chose one single thing that is the most pressing.

Being singularly minded is the pathway to successfully obtaining what have desired and earnestly seek after.

Our Focus: BEING SINGLE MINDED

There are times when we need to be single minded and Jesus' spoke of being single minded. *Luke 11:33-The only source of light for the body is the eye. **When you look at people and want to help them, you are full of light.** But when you look at people in a selfish way, you are full of darkness. 35 So be careful! Don't let the light in you become darkness. Easy-to-Read Version.*

*Luke 11:33 The lamp of the body is the eye. **When your eye is single focus, sound, and fulfilling its function,** also your whole body is well lighted. But when it is pernicious, also your body is full of darkness. Kenneth S. Wuest*

Its function.

IT IS when we look at people, we are wanting to help them and this means that **we** are operating **in God's light, in his generous and compassionate way** that he does things.

SO, IT IS IMPORTANT that we **DO NOT** allow our light to be darkened or lessened through the choice of selfish ways.

In today's society people have a multiplicity of options to choose from but sadly this often leads to **indecisiveness and a failure to make long term commitment** to those things that matter in life, including God.

A testimony that inspired me! Recently I was reminded of advice given by a pastor to another Christian brother who was struggling with waiting for a response from an official Government department to a particular application that had been made to them. But in his waiting, he became anxious and worried and started to think what about what if this or that happened to be the answer? The pastor told the brother to **put the copy of his application in a cupboard and don't look at it again**, and wait for the answer to come.

The pastor in effect was saying to that brother **don't be double minded but be singularly focused on one thing – the provision of God.**

King David wrote! Psalms 27:4 I have asked the Lord **for one thing; one thing only** do I want: to live in the Lord's house all my life, to marvel there at his goodness, and to ask for his guidance. TEV

Psalms 27:4 **The one thing** I want from God, **the thing I seek most of all**, is the privilege of meditating in his Temple, living in his presence every day of my life, delighting in his incomparable perfections and glory. TLB

Joshua said! NOT ONE THING of God's promises has failed.

Joshua 23:14 And, behold, this day I am going the way of all the earth: and ye know in all your hearts and in all your souls, that not one thing hath failed of all the good things which the Lord your God spake concerning you; all are come to pass unto you, and **not one thing hath failed** thereof. KJV

ONE THING LACKING:

Mark 10:17, 21 17 As Jesus was starting out on his way to Jerusalem, a man came running up to him, knelt down, and asked, "Good Teacher, what must I do to inherit eternal life?" 21 Looking at the man, **Jesus felt genuine love for him.** "There is still one thing you haven't done," he told him. "Go and sell all your possessions and give the money to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven. Then come, follow me." NLT

Neglect! Sometimes we need to **acknowledge** that there are things that we have neglected through preoccupation with other things or slackened the maintenance of self-discipline in our daily living.

Being transparent and accountable! Is an essential quality required of every believer relative to their lack or failure.

God's correction is not his rejection: verse 21 – "Jesus felt genuine love for him". NLT verse 21 – Jesus, looking at him, loved him, NKJ

Hebrews 12:6-7 The Lord disciplines everyone he loves. He severely disciplines everyone he accepts as his child. "7 Endure your discipline. God corrects you as a father corrects his children. All children are disciplined by their fathers. GOD'S WORD

It is because he loves us that he corrects us and continues to accept us as his children - not rejecting us.

ONE THING IS NEEDED :

Choosing the right (best) thing! Luke 10:42 but **only one thing is needed.** Mary has chosen what is better, and it will not be taken away from her." NIV.

ONE THING STILL TO BE DONE: Luke 18:22 When Jesus heard his answer, he said, "There is still one thing you haven't done. Sell all your possessions and give the money to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven. Then come, follow me." NLT

ONE THING I KNOW:

John 9:25 The man responded, "I don't know if he's a sinner or not. **But I do know one thing.** I used to be blind, but now I can see." GOD'S WORD.

Experiencing an encounter with the miracle worker (Christ) gave him that unassailable knowledge.

And personal experience caused him to have total and complete knowledge of what took place in his journey from blindness to sight (seeing).

Let us encounter this Christ in the many aspects of faith and godliness as it will leave us with an assurance and sense of confidence.

ONE THING I DO:

Forgetting, straining toward, pressing on!

Leaving behind the past (good and bad) and **straining (stretching forth)** to what is ahead.

Philippians 3:13-14 13 Brothers, I do not consider that I have made it my own. **But one thing I do: forgetting** what lies behind and **straining** forward to what lies ahead, 14 I press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus. ESV

In effect the apostle is saying don't stay focused on your ACCOMPLISHMENTS but on the OPPORTUNITIES (that are ahead of you)

It is too easy to be focused more on our past successes instead of those amazing things that God has ahead of us.

SO, LET US PUT ENERGY INTO OUR DESTINY AND NOT OUR HISTORY. Going back over the why's and wherefores of the past **only gives energy to the History** (the past) – **So give energy to your destiny** (what is ahead of you).

WORKING TOGETHER AS ONE WITH ONE PURPOSE

Philippians 1:27 27 **Only one thing concerns me:** Be sure that you live in a way that brings honor to the Good News of Christ. Then whether I come and visit you or am away from you, I will hear that you are standing strong with **one purpose**, that you **work together as one** for the faith of the Good News, NCV

Amen – Pastor Barry